



ASUS confirms the Eee PC T101H - a touchscreen Atom based netbook with built-in GPS



BOINC, the computing network does three times more work than the world's fastest supercomputer



Contact

Sony India

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Price: Rs. 4,490

Specifications

Supraaural, foldable headband, single AAA powered active noise cancellation.

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	6
Build Quality	5.5
Value for money.....	7
Overall	6.5

The MDR NC7/WM has an unnecessarily long name and is an active noise cancelling headphone – the noise cancellation circuitry is battery powered by a single AAA cell. The headband armature gives the impression of being a bit flimsy, but this is no doubt the result of its folding nature.

The earcups are slightly smaller than full-size circumaurals but a bit larger than some supraaural designs like Grados headphones. However, since they don't encompass the ear entirely

Sony MDR NC7/WM

Unnecessary shushing

and the foam padding sits atop the outer ear we're classifying them as supraaural. Mind you, because they're plastic and light they won't fall off because of the loose headband.

One of the oddities we noticed is that enabling and disabling noise cancellation causes a lot of variation in the sound signature and quite frankly this should not be. In fact, when using NC, the volume level also goes up. That being said the enabling NC does drown out some small external sounds although even without this feature turned on the headphones isolate pretty well. With NC turned off we found the bass to be lacking and it's not just a lack of punch but feels anaemic overall. The highs also sound thin and shrill, and the soundstage

narrows by around 30 per cent. Turning NC on brings a certain amount of warmth to the vocals while the bass, although still weak, is a bit more noticeable. The highs lose their shrill nature. Any comparisons with other noise cancelling sets are pointless since the Sennheiser PXC 450 we tested is very expensive in comparison.

But this one is not for discerning listeners, particularly since we couldn't figure out why enabling a feature meant to isolate external noise should change the way this headphone sounds. At Rs. 4,490 the MDR NC7 is priced reasonably well for a NC set, but you could buy a pair of quality in-ear monitors for the same price that would provide better sound quality.

Razer Carcharias

Where's the comfort?

The Razer Carcharias head phone has a circumaural closed-can design, with an integrated microphone. They're pretty light, and the foam cushion on the head strap rests nicely on the contours of your head. The height adjusters are smoother than most headphones we've seen. After testing the microphone we agree with its forte as a communications package – the microphone quality is quite good and it does manage to pick up, primarily your voice, without much background noise. The mic is also positioned in such a way that there is no disturbance caused by breathing or puffs of breath. There is a mic on/off switch on the cable, which comes

in handy.

The pads are soft, but the pressure exerted by the device is a tad too much, especially when using it for long. On using the device for more than 20 hours, at least four hours at a time, it still didn't feel comfortable. Perhaps the headphone needs a bit more breaking in until they ease up the pressure at the base of the ear.

As far as audio quality goes the whole audio spectrum seemed narrowed. They function without any distortion even at high volume. The sound is not too bassy and we can go on about the mids and highs being repressed, but hey, let's not forget



this is a gaming device. They will perform decently enough for listening to tunes, but its core function is gaming. Bottom line is that this is definitely not a device for audio appreciation. What it is however, is a thorough bred and quite expensive gaming device.

Contact

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Web site: www.razerzone.com

Price: Rs. 5,999

Specifications

Headphones:

Frequency Response:

20 - 20,000 Hz

Impedance: 32 Ohms, 40 mm neodymium drivers

Microphone:

Frequency Response:

50 - 16,000 Hz, 3 meters cable

RATINGS

Features	7
Performance	6.5
Build Quality	7
Value for money.....	4
Overall	6